The New Nationalism

Theodore Roosevelt · August 31, 1910

Source: Theodore Roosevelt, "The New Nationalism" (1910). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> At Osawatomie, the former president called for a strong federal government to serve as "steward of the public welfare" — regulating property, protecting labor, and putting "men" above property — the platform of his 1912 Progressive (Bull Moose) campaign.

The man who wrongly holds that every human right is secondary to his profit must now give way to the advocate of human welfare, who rightly maintains that every man holds his property subject to the general right of the community to regulate its use to whatever degree the public welfare may require it.

[. . .]

I believe in shaping the ends of government to protect property as well as human welfare. Normally, and in the long run, the ends are the same; but whenever the alternative must be faced, I am for men and not for property, as you were in the Civil War. I am far from underestimating the importance of dividends; but I rank dividends below human character.